

# CORNELIUS ERFORT

Post-doctoral Researcher • Witten/Herdecke University

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## CURRENT POSITION

since Sep 2024

### Post-doctoral Researcher

WITTEN/HERDECKE UNIVERSITY

Research Project *Election Forecasts for the German Federal Election 2025* — [zweitstimme.org](https://zweitstimme.org).

## PREVIOUS POSITIONS

Sep 2021 – Aug 2024

### Doctoral Researcher

HERTIE SCHOOL & HUMBOLDT-UNIVERSITÄT ZU BERLIN

Research Training Group *DYNAMICS*.

Oct 2023 – Aug 2024

### Doctoral Researcher

HUMBOLDT-UNIVERSITÄT ZU BERLIN

Research Project *MINISTERIALLOBBY*.

May 2021 – Jul 2022

### Doctoral Researcher

HUMBOLDT-UNIVERSITÄT ZU BERLIN & FREIE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN

Cluster of Excellence *SCRIPTS*.

Dec 2016 – Apr 2021

### Student Assistant

HUMBOLDT-UNIVERSITÄT ZU BERLIN

Chair of Comparative Political Behavior.

May 2015 – Mar 2017

### Student Assistant

TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN

Institute of Machine Tools and Production.

## EDUCATION

Sep 2021 – Mar 2025

### PhD in Political Science (*summa cum laude*)

HUMBOLDT-UNIVERSITÄT ZU BERLIN

Dissertation: *Political Parties' Voter Targeting and Campaign Communication Strategies*.

Committee: Heike Klüver, Anselm Hager, Hanna Schwander (all Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin), Mark A. Kayser (Hertie School), Sara B. Hobolt (LSE).

Sep 2023 – Dec 2023

### Research Visit, Department of Government

LONDON SCHOOL OF ECONOMICS AND POLITICAL SCIENCE

Supervisor: Prof. Sara B. Hobolt.

Oct 2019 – May 2021

### M.A. in Social Sciences (*Grade 1.0*) — HUMBOLDT-UNIVERSITÄT ZU BERLIN.

Sep 2020 – Dec 2020

**Exchange Program** (declined due to pandemic) — NORTHWESTERN UNIVERSITY, CHICAGO.

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|---------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Oct 2015 – Mar 2019 | <b>B.A. in Social Sciences</b> (Grade 1.6) — HUMBOLDT-UNIVERSITÄT ZU BERLIN.                         |
| Aug 2017 – Dec 2017 | <b>Exchange Program</b> , Mexico City — CENTRO DE INVESTIGACIÓN Y DOCENCIA ECONÓMICAS (CIDE).        |
| Oct 2011 – Jul 2015 | <b>B.Sc. in Industrial Engineering &amp; Management</b> (Grade 2.3) — TECHNISCHE UNIVERSITÄT BERLIN. |

## PEER-REVIEWED PUBLICATIONS

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[Google Scholar profile.](#)

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|------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026 | <b>Gendered Targeting: Do Parties Tailor Their Campaign Ads to Women?</b><br>Cornelius Erfort. <i>The Journal of Politics</i> . <a href="#">↗</a>                                                                                                                                      |
| 2026 | <b>How Swing Model Assumptions Shape Vote-to-Seat Predictions</b><br>Cornelius Erfort, Thomas Gschwend, Lukas F. Stoetzer, and Simon Munzert. <i>Electoral Studies</i> . <a href="#">↗</a>                                                                                             |
| 2026 | <b>Parties' Issue Responsiveness Between Elections</b><br>Cornelius Erfort, Lukas F. Stoetzer, and Heike Klüver. <i>West European Politics</i> . <a href="#">↗</a>                                                                                                                     |
| 2026 | <b>The 2026 Europe Report of the Lancet Countdown on Health and Climate Change: Narrowing Window for Decisive Health Action</b><br>Hedi K. Kriit et al. <i>The Lancet Public Health</i> . <a href="#">↗</a>                                                                            |
| 2025 | <b>Buying Voter Support for Unpopular Policies: Evidence from German Nuclear Power Plants</b><br>Cornelius Erfort, António Valentim, and Heike Klüver. <i>Electoral Studies</i> . <a href="#">↗</a>                                                                                    |
| 2025 | <b>An Election Forecasting Model for Subnational Elections</b><br>Lukas F. Stoetzer, Cornelius Erfort, Hannah Rajski, Thomas Gschwend, Simon Munzert, and Elias Koch. <i>Electoral Studies</i> . <a href="#">↗</a>                                                                     |
| 2025 | <b>The Zweitstimme Forecast for the German Federal Election 2025: Coalition Majorities and Vacant Districts</b><br>Cornelius Erfort, Lukas F. Stoetzer, Thomas Gschwend, Elias Koch, Simon Munzert, and Hannah Rajski. <i>PS: Political Science &amp; Politics</i> . <a href="#">↗</a> |
| 2024 | <b>Targeting Voters Online: How Parties' Campaigns Differ</b><br>Cornelius Erfort. <i>Electoral Studies</i> . <a href="#">↗</a>                                                                                                                                                        |
| 2023 | <b>The PARTYPRESS Database: A New Comparative Database of Parties' Press Releases</b><br>Cornelius Erfort, Lukas F. Stoetzer, and Heike Klüver. <i>Research &amp; Politics</i> . <a href="#">↗</a>                                                                                     |

## WORK IN PROGRESS

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- The Labor Market for Lobbying: Expertise, Political Connections, and Career Paths**  
with Jan Stuckatz, Felix Hartmann, and Heike Klüver.
- Do Attacks Affect Politicians? Hostility and Its Consequences in Germany, 2021–2025**  
with Elias Koch.

**Measuring Party Issue Attention Between Elections: A Cross-National, Sentence-Level Database of Party Press Releases**

with Zachary P. Dickson.

**Parties' (missed) opportunities for targeting issue messages in political campaigns**

with Christina Gahn.

**Stacking Election Forecasts**

with Lukas F. Stoetzer. Under review.

**How Should We Communicate Election Polls?**

with Elias Koch, Linus Hagemann, Simon Munzert, Hannah Rajski, Thomas Gschwend, and Lukas F. Stoetzer.

**Can an Interactive Dashboard Teach Polling Literacy? Evidence from a Large-Scale Experiment**

with Simon Munzert, Linus Hagemann, Elias Koch, Hannah Rajski, Thomas Gschwend, and Lukas F. Stoetzer.

**Measuring Protest Through News Articles: Validating Manual and Semi-Supervised Methods Using Government Data.** [↗](#)

## OTHER PROJECTS

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| 2021 | <b>Election Dataset Germany 1953–2021</b><br>County-level results made comparable over time using areal weighted interpolation. <a href="#">🌐</a> |
| 2017 | <b>erststimme2017.de</b><br>Prediction of the district vote at the German Elections 2017.                                                         |

## SELECTED PRESENTATIONS

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|---------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2026    | APSA, Boston.                                                               |
| 2026    | European Political Science Society (EPSS), Belfast.                         |
| 2026    | LSE Climate and Political Behaviour Workshop.                               |
| 2025    | MZES Social Science Data Lab.                                               |
| 2025    | Lunchtalk — Arbeitskreis <i>Wahlen und politische Einstellungen</i> , DVPW. |
| 2025    | APSA.                                                                       |
| 2025    | MPSA.                                                                       |
| 2024    | DVPW.                                                                       |
| 2024    | Transformations of Democracy Junior Scholars Workshop, WZB Berlin.          |
| 2022–25 | EPSA (2022, 2023, 2024, 2025).                                              |

## SERVICE TO THE DISCIPLINE

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| Reviewer | <i>The Journal of Politics</i> (JOP); <i>Political Science Research and Methods</i> (PSRM); <i>Electoral Studies</i> ; <i>European Journal of Political Research</i> (EJPR); <i>Political Research Exchange</i> (PRX); <i>Party Politics</i> ; <i>Environmental Politics</i> ; <i>Comparative European Politics</i> ; <i>Politische Vierteljahresschrift</i> (PVS). |
| 2022     | <b>Student Representative</b> , Research Training Group DYNAMICS.                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                   |

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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| 2025, 2026       | <b>Automated Web Data Collection</b><br>PhD workshop. Research Training Group DYNAMICS, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin<br>May 2025; April 2026. Instructor.  |
| 2023, 2025, 2026 | <b>Issue Agendas, Text Classification, and Transformer Models</b><br>Guest lectures, M.A., Department of Social Sciences, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin<br>January 2023; February 2025; February 2026.                                       |
| 2023             | <b>Automated Web Data Collection and Text as Data</b><br>B.A., Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin. Lecturer.                                                   |
| 2022             | <b>Comparative Politics and International Relations</b><br>B.A., Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin. Lecturer.                                                                                                                                    |

## FUNDING & AWARDS

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|------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 2025 | <b>LSE Seed Research Fund</b> (with Zach Dickson) — GBP 9,600.                                                                                        |
| 2020 | <b>Fulbright Travel Grant</b> (declined due to pandemic) — EUR ~2,000.<br><b>DAAD PROMOS Scholarship USA</b> (declined due to pandemic) — EUR ~3,000. |
| 2017 | <b>DAAD PROMOS Scholarship Mexico</b> — EUR ~3,000.                                                                                                   |

## ADDITIONAL TRAINING

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| 2024 | <b>New Directions in Causal Inference</b> , by Prof. Ryan T. Moore, Ph.D. (American University).<br>DYNAMICS Graduate Program, Humboldt-Universität zu Berlin.                                                                                                                                |
| 2023 | <b>Image Analysis</b> , by Prof. Michelle Torres (UCLA); <b>Good Scientific Practice</b> , by Dr. Christian Dumpitak (iGrad); <b>Data Protection in PhD Projects</b> , by Oliver Watteler (GESIS).                                                                                            |
| 2022 | <b>Essex Summer School in Social Science Data Analysis</b> .<br><i>Causal Inference and Experiments in the Social Sciences</i> , by Prof. Ryan T. Moore, Ph.D. (American University).                                                                                                         |
| 2021 | <b>Online Experiments</b> , by Dr. Amalia Alvarez-Benjumea (MPI); <b>Survey Experiments</b> , by Sofia Breitenstein (UAB); <b>Spatial Data Analysis</b> , by Prof. Dr. Karsten Donnay (UZH); <b>Beyond Counting Words: Working with Word Embeddings</b> , by Prof. Dr. Damian Trilling (UvA). |

## LANGUAGES & TECHNICAL SKILLS

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|-------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Languages   | German (native); English (advanced, TOEFL iBT 112/130); Spanish (fluent, UNIcert II).   |
| Programming | R, Python, Git/GitHub, Stata.                                                           |
| Typesetting | $\text{\LaTeX}$ , MS Office.                                                            |
| Other       | Web scraping, data visualization, quantitative text analysis, automated image analysis. |

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*Last updated September 14, 2026.*